

Key numbers

Share of take-home saved
~29.8%
25.9% to 33.2%

Share of total pay saved, match included
~31.7%

Federal tax rate
~10.9%
marginal 22.0%

Left over each month
~\$1,666 a month

Owned minus owed
\$54,840

Everything owed
\$12,410

How long cash lasts
~3 months
4 months at the floor

The portfolio that pays for life
~\$1,296,000
0
\$1,253,427 to \$1,338,375

How far along
~4.2%
of net worth

When the portfolio could carry you
Feb 2050
age 50, best 47, worst 54

Changes since last time (17 Sep 2026)

- Savings: balance was \$9,800, now \$10,200
- Sapphire Preferred: balance was \$980, now \$640
- Restaurants and takeout: amount was \$250 to \$350, now \$240 to \$320

Safe to spend today: \$3,296. Tightest day: Oct 2026, \$3,296.
Decisions on the table: Condo in Oakland (\$650 a month more).

Your next wins

- You already have a lean month covered
- You already have a full month covered
- Pay off Sapphire Preferred in Nov 2026
- Japan with my sister in Oct 2027
- Full cushion in Feb 2028

Most important to know

- Housing takes about two fifths of take-home
- The 401k match is fully taken; the Roth IRA fills about half of its room
- Cash covers about three months of full spending

What is working

- Four accounts, all with named beneficiaries except the HSA
- Savings land every month without fail

What needs work

- Restaurants and clothing are still rough numbers
- Parking tickets are a \$480 a year habit

Do more, do less

More: Keep the Roth transfer automatic; move the gifts line to a known figure after the holidays.
Less: Street parking downtown on Thursdays.

To-dos

Task	Owner	Due
Send the 401k statement	Maya	20 Oct 2026
Confirm the Sapphire hotel credit posted	Eli	12 Oct 2026

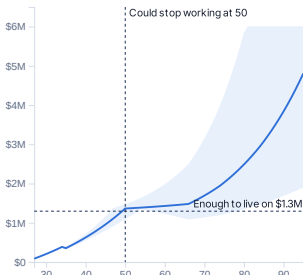
Goals

- Japan with my sister: \$6,000 by Oct 2027
- Condo down payment: ~\$80,000 by Jun 2035

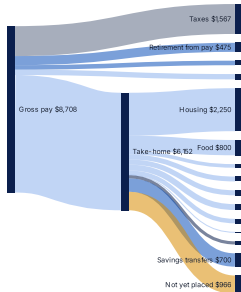
Bring next time

- Direct clients: Freelance illustration (gross pay)
- From memory or a statement: Tutoring, occasional (amount), Restaurants and takeout (amount), Clothing and personal care (amount), Travel (amount) and 3 more
- Lumen Health: Product designer (costs of working)
- NJ Division of Taxation: NJ estimated tax (amount)
- Unum: Long-term disability (coverage)
- Wells Fargo: Bilt (credit limit)

What you could have over time



Where the money goes each month



Assumes 5% a year after inflation (3% to 7%), a 4.0% withdrawal rate and Social Security from 67, in today's dollars.